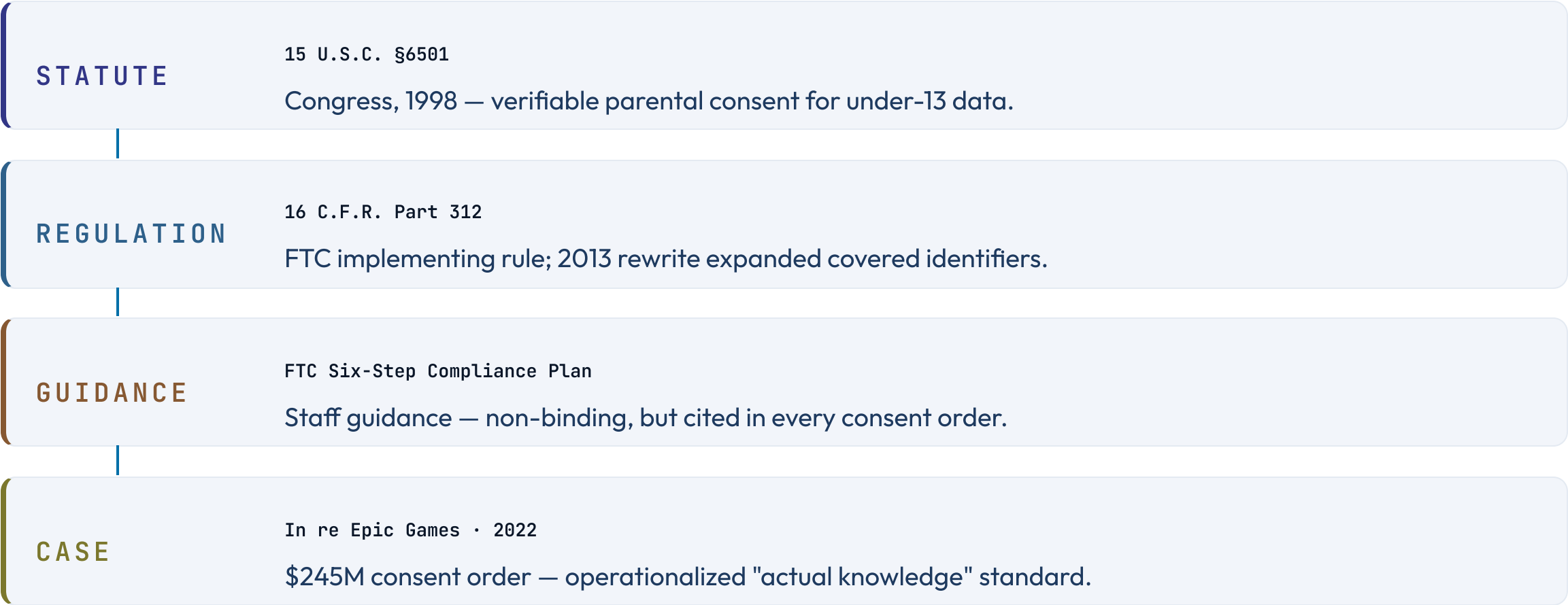


PROGRESSION · TIMELINE · STRUCTURE

authority-chain

Provenance chain — statute to regulation to guidance to case, walked in order.

The chain descends from statute to practice.



branching forks the chain where authority splits.

STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501 COPPA, 1998

16 C.F.R. Part 312 FTC implementing rule

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan staff guidance

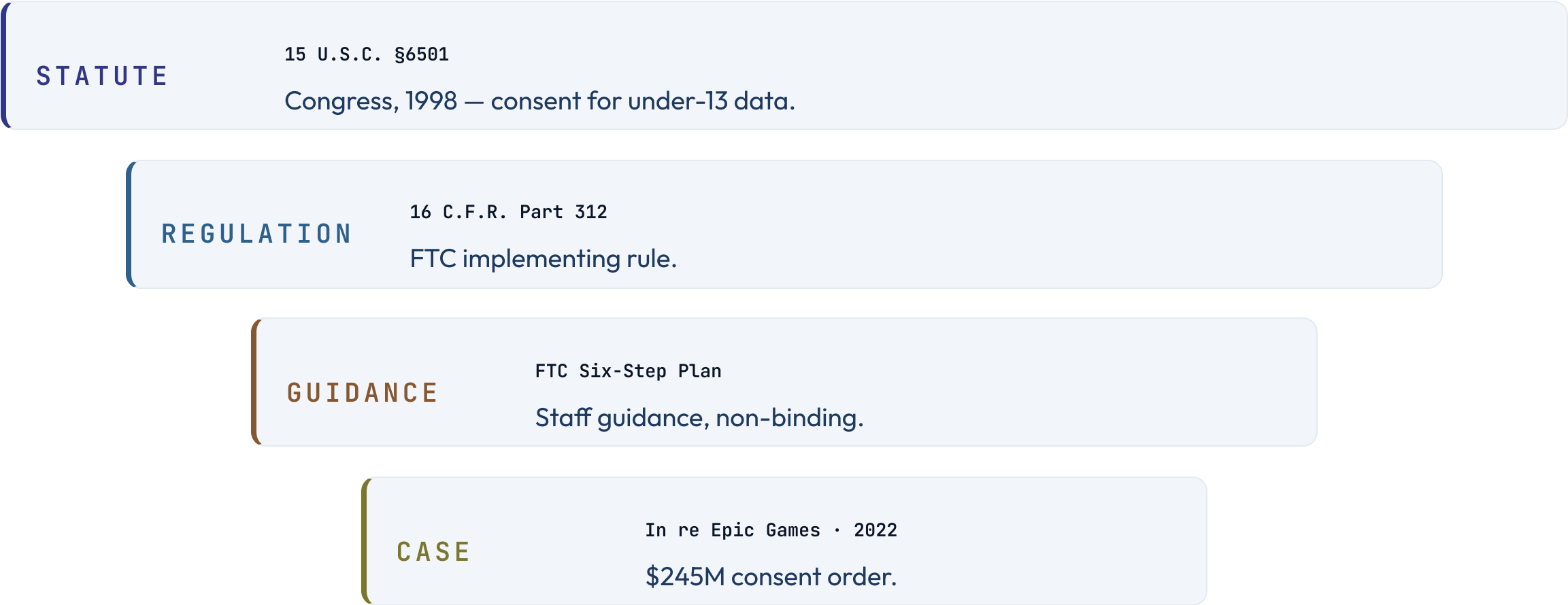
In re Epic Games • 2022 \$245M consent order

In re YouTube/Google • 2019 \$170M consent order

trail walks the chain as a breadcrumb.



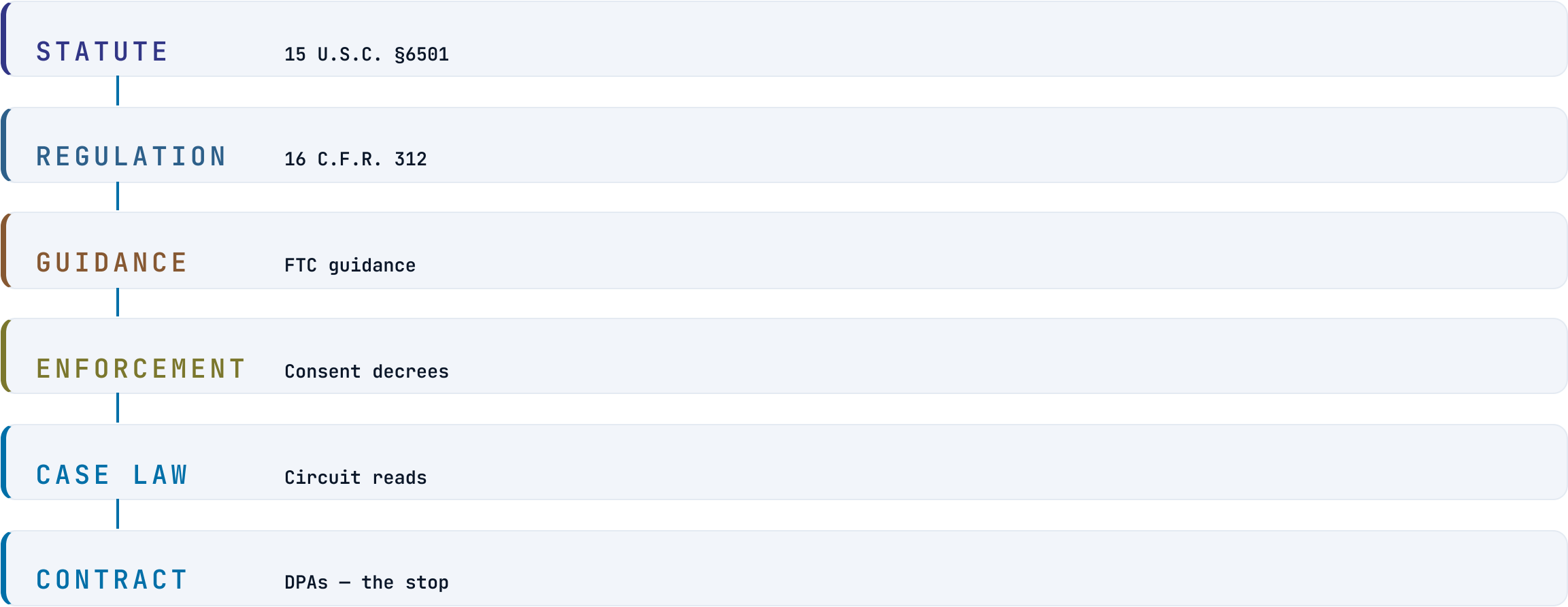
pyramid weights the tiers by force.



bracket groups the tiers by actor.

TREATY	Charter of Fundamental Rights, Art. 8 EU primary law — protection of personal data is a fundamental right.
REGULATION	GDPR (EU) 2016/679 Directly applicable across all member states; sets the Art. 83 fine tiers.
GUIDANCE	EDPB Guidelines 04/2022 Harmonized methodology for calculating administrative fines.
DECISION	DPC v. Meta • 2023 €1.2B fine — the largest GDPR penalty to date.

Six tiers is the chain's ceiling.



The chain descends from statute to practice.

STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.

REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule; 2013 rewrite expanded covered identifiers.

GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan

Staff guidance — non-binding, but cited in every consent order.

CASE

In re Epic Games · 2022

\$245M consent order — operationalized "actual knowledge" standard.

The chain descends from statute to practice.

STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.

REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule; 2013 rewrite expanded covered identifiers.

GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan

Staff guidance — non-binding, but cited in every consent order.

CASE

In re Epic Games • 2022

\$245M consent order — operationalized "actual knowledge" standard.

The chain descends from statute to practice.

STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.

REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule; 2013 rewrite expanded covered identifiers.

GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan

Staff guidance — non-binding, but cited in every consent order.

CASE

In re Epic Games • 2022

\$245M consent order — operationalized "actual knowledge" standard.

When NOT to reach for authority-chain.

Flat list of citations. If the rows have no tier hierarchy, `list-criteria` or `regulatory-update`. authority-chain earns its chrome only when the descent from statute to case is the point.

Missing citation chip. The inline-code citation is the row's anchor; without it the gloss reads as opinion. Always cite, even for guidance and case rows.

Out-of-order tiers. The chain reads as a descent: statute first, case last. Reversing it or skipping a tier breaks the metaphor the audience is using to follow you.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`regulatory-update` — period-bounded changelog rather than a single rule's lineage

`list-criteria` — flat enumeration of requirements without tier hierarchy

`list-steps` — the rows are procedural steps rather than authority tiers